

Baazee.com

Trading on this auction site is fun, and addictive

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It is a Web site we are familiar with, yet we hardly know how it works. Baazee, arguably India's most accessed e-commerce site, has hundreds of links that give you thousands of options. And therein lies the problem—how to create order out of those options? A few pointers would help:

Register

You need to register with Baazee to conduct any transaction. The procedure is simple, and similar to the one followed by other Web sites.

Search

You can search products in two ways: Either use the Search field from the

something equally ridiculous. If the final bid is below the Reserve Price, the transaction is considered complete. Though we have all heard stories about people buying stuff at dirt cheap prices, don't hold your breath, at the end of the day, the sellers are here to make money, not lose it.

MaxBid: This new concept by Baazee involves a little thinking, a bit of luck and some 'Baazee Points', which can get you that proverbial 'steal of a deal'.

Here's how it works: Buying stuff in the Quick Buys section earns you Baazee points. Redeem these to enter MaxBid. A MaxBid item is sold at a 90 per cent discount on its MRP. So, a Rs 20,000 video camera is sold on MaxBid for Rs 2,000. Use a few hundred Baazee Points to bid on such products, and remember to bid as close to the MaxBid as possible. All bids are



The Baazee Home Page shows the three steps to buy

Pay

The most common form of payment is Cash on Delivery (COD), popular among individuals who are wary of revealing their credit card number on the Web, or small businesses operating on Baazee. Bigger vendors accept credit cards, demand drafts, cheques and electronic bank transfers.

Sell

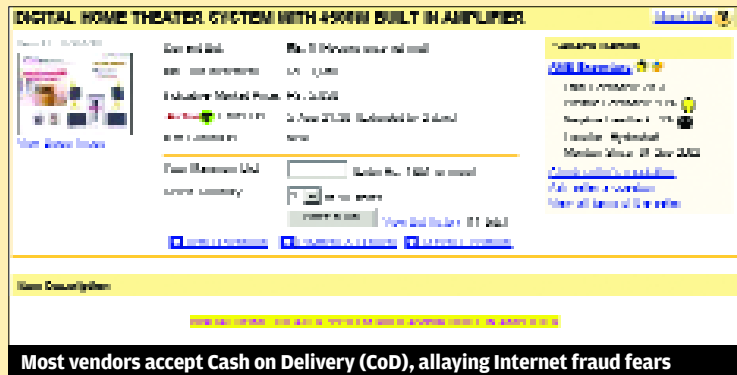
Baazee is a great place to set up your own business online without investing in expensive real estate. There are three ways to sell your goods: Auction, QuickBuy or Classifieds. You can 'Auction' absolutely anything except real estate and services. QuickBuy is for anything except real estate, services and automobiles, and Classifieds are only for real estate and services. Depending on what you are selling, choose between Auction and QuickBuy.

Remember that QuickBuy is a fixed-price sale—so people will either like or dislike your offer. Auctions, on the other hand, let people bid on the item, and you may end up with more than what you expected. However, you should know that Indian buyers are not likely to pay extra.

After you choose the way you are going to sell, you have to select a category. Choose one that your goods fit into, and you will see a verification page with relevant details. Click on Verify Me, and Baazee's customer service promises to contact you within 24 hours. Once they complete their verification process, you are informed via e-mail, and are then allowed to put up your item for sale.

Now that eBay.com has bought Baazee, we can expect more innovative buying and selling options from the site. Until then, keep searching for the proverbial 'steal of a deal.'

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Most vendors accept Cash on Delivery (CoD), allaying Internet fraud fears

home page, or browse through the various categories by clicking the respective links.

Buy

There are five different ways items are sold on Baazee:

QuickBuy: If you like a product that is priced within your budget, click on Buy Now. There is no auction process in this category; hence bidding is out of the question. The buying process is the simplest here. **Auctions:** Search for and select an item. Each item is accompanied by a 'Current Bid Status', which indicates the highest bid for that product thus far.

Often there is a 'Reserve Price' for a product. A seller usually sets a Reserve Price so that he doesn't have to sell at a ridiculously low price if no one bids on his item. Otherwise, people might be able to buy a car for Rs 10, or

compared once the maximum bids limit (as in, the number of bids) is reached. Two or more biddings of the same price are discarded, and the winner is the highest unique bid. Hence, you can get that video camera for any price below Rs 2,000—if no other bidder chooses the same bid amount, or a unique bid that's higher. **Secondhand Goods:** The Secondhand Goods store sells anything from computer memory to laptops, or sofa sets to houses—all at discounted prices. However, before you take the plunge, remember the phrase "Let the buyer beware". If you opt for secondhand, it's always at your own risk, since there is no warranty for any of the goods you buy.

The 99 Store: Another innovative section for those with slim wallets. Purchase anything in this store for Rs 99 or less. T-shirts, VCDs, pendants, wallets, and more—they are all here.



eBay buys out Baazee

This past June, eBay bought Baazee.com Inc. and its subsidiary Baazee.com India Pvt Ltd, for \$50 million (Rs 230 crore). In turn, Baazee.com will use its relationship with eBay to further develop its business and strengthen its position in India's e-commerce market.